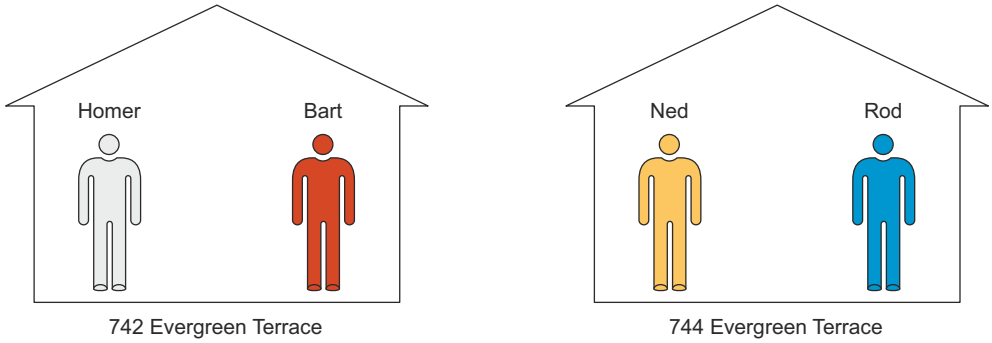


Figure 2.1 Two houses with two people in each. Each house represents a website, and the people in the house are web pages.

CORS requests, including the `XMLHttpRequest` and `XDomainRequest` objects. Next it looks at how the HTML5 `<canvas>` element uses CORS to load images. It ends with a look at jQuery support for CORS. The server-side details of CORS will be covered in chapter 3.

2.1 What is a cross-origin request?

Before learning how to make a cross-origin request, let's define what a cross-origin request is. Think of a website as a house, and each page on the website as an inhabitant of that house. Suppose there are houses located at 742 Evergreen Terrace and 744 Evergreen Terrace, and each house has two residents: Homer and Bart at 742 Evergreen Terrace, and Ned and Rod at 744 Evergreen Terrace (as shown in figure 2.1).

An HTTP request is a conversation between two people. When Homer talks to Bart, the conversation takes place solely within the confines of the house. This is called a *same-origin request*. If Homer calls Ned, the conversation crosses the boundaries of the house. This is called a *cross-origin request*. Figure 2.2 shows the distinction between a same-origin and a cross-origin request.

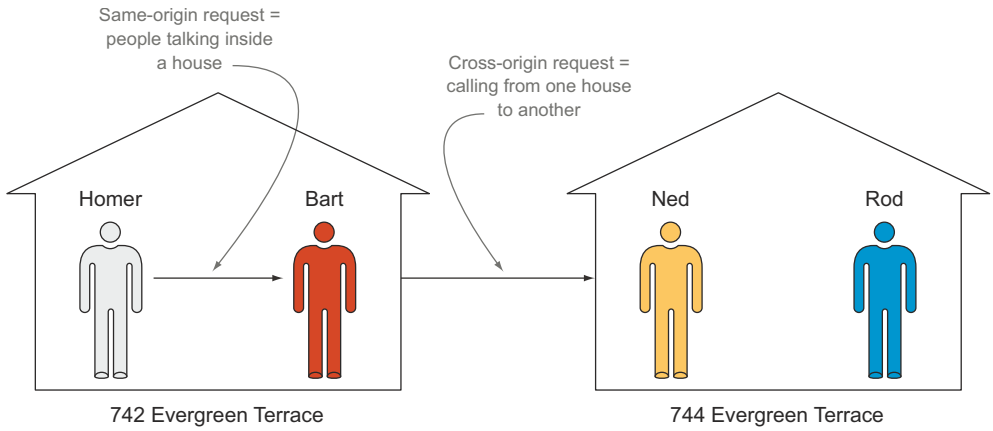


Figure 2.2 Illustrating the difference between a same-origin and a cross-origin request